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MySQL Aliases

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MySQL Aliases

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An alias is created with the `AS` keyword, and is often used to make a column name more readable.

An alias only exists for the duration of that query.

Alias for Column Syntax

```
SELECT column_name AS alias_name
FROM table_name;
```

Alias for Table Syntax

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Demo Database

Below is a selection from the "Customers" table in the Northwind sample database:

CustomerID	CustomerName	ContactName	Address	City	PostalCode	Co
1	Alfreds Futterkiste	Maria Anders	Obere Str. 57	Berlin	12209	Ge
2	Ana Trujillo Emparedados y helados	Ana Trujillo	Avda. de la Constitución 2222	México D.F.	05021	Me
3	Antonio Moreno Taquería	Antonio Moreno	Mataderos 2312	México D.F.	05023	Me
4	Around the Horn	Thomas Hardy	120 Hanover Sq.	London	WA1 1DP	UK
5	Berglunds snabbköp	Christina Berglund	Berguvsvägen 8	Luleå	S-958 22	Sw

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Alias for Columns

The following SQL creates two aliases, one for the CustomerID column and one for the CustomerName column:

Example

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```
SELECT CustomerID AS ID, CustomerName AS Customer
FROM Customers;
```

Try it Yourself »

Alias with Spaces

If you want your alias to contain one or more spaces, like "Contact Person", surround the aliasname with single or double quotes:

Example

```
SELECT CustomerName AS Customer, ContactName AS "Contact Person"
FROM Customers;
```

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Concatenate Columns

The following SQL creates an alias named "Address" that combine four columns (Address, PostalCode, City and Country):

Example

```
SELECT CustomerName, CONCAT_WS(', ', Address, PostalCode, City, Country) AS
Address
FROM Customers;
```

Try it Yourself »

Alias for Tables

The following SQL selects all the orders from the customer with CustomerID=4 (Around the Horn). We use the "Customers" and "Orders" tables, and give them the table aliases of "c" and "o" respectively (Here we use aliases to make the SQL shorter):

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```
SELECT o.OrderID, o.OrderDate, c.CustomerName
FROM Customers AS c, Orders AS o
WHERE c.CustomerName='Around the Horn' AND c.CustomerID=o.CustomerID;
```

Try it Yourself »

The following SQL is the same as above, but without aliases:

Example

```
SELECT Orders.OrderID, Orders.OrderDate, Customers.CustomerName
FROM Customers, Orders
WHERE Customers.CustomerName='Around the Horn' AND
Customers.CustomerID=Orders.CustomerID;
```

Try it Yourself »

Aliases are useful when:

- There are more than one table involved in a query
- Functions are used in the query
- Column names are long or not very readable
- Two or more columns are combined together

Exercise ?

If an alias contain spaces, what is the correct characters for surrounding the alias?

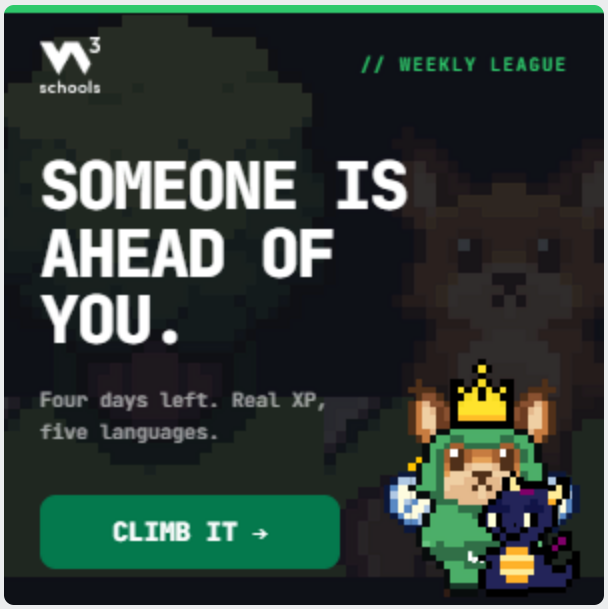
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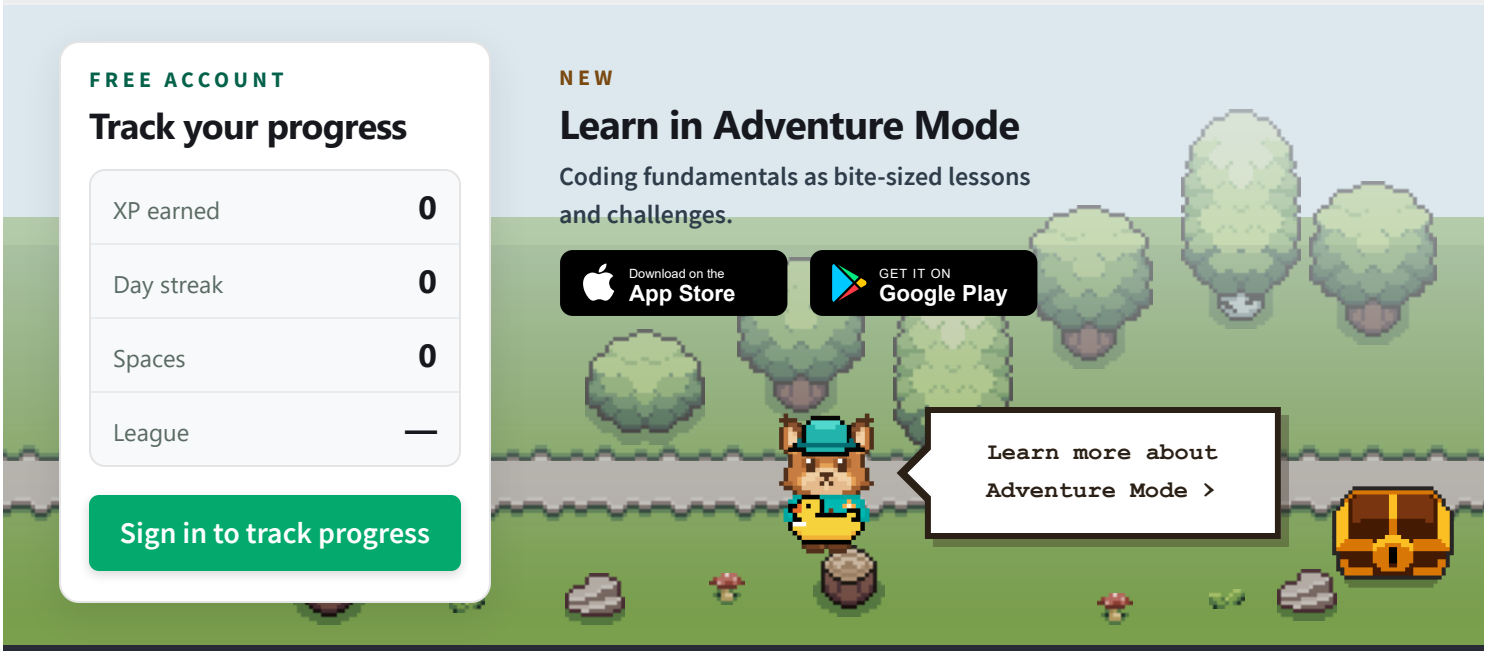


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